

Alyssa Smith

Curriculum Vitae

Network Science Institute
Northeastern University
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🌐 Website
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Research Interests

social media, network science, computational social science, natural language processing.

Academic Appointments and Affiliations

Fall 2026 **Assistant Professor, Department of Mathematics and Computer Science, College of the Holy Cross, Worcester, MA.**

Education

- 09/2021–03/2026 **PhD, Network Science, Northeastern University, Boston, MA.**
Supervisors: Brooke Foucault Welles & David Lazer
Dissertation: Emergent Power in Information Ecosystems on Social Media
- 09/2021–08/2023 **Master of Science, Network Science, Northeastern University, Boston, MA.**
- 09/2013–05/2017 **Bachelor of Science, Humanities and Engineering with Computer Science and Comparative Media Studies, MIT, Cambridge, MA.**
Thesis: The Discourse: An Online Debate

Fellowships, Awards, and Distinctions

- 04/2026 **Northeastern University Laural and Scroll 100.**
- 07/2025 **UC Berkeley/Oxford Internet Institute Doctoral Consortium.**
- 06/2025 **International Communication Association Doctoral Consortium.**
- 03/2024 **Network Science Institute NetSeed Grant Recipient.**
Granted \$10,000 for a year-long project titled “An Annotated Dataset of Local and National U.S. News Articles about Transgender Issues”
- 03/2023 **NSF GRFP Fellowship Awardee.**
in Social Sciences - Computationally Intensive Research. Awarded \$159,000 for five years of graduate study under Grant No. 1938052

Publications

Book Chapters

- 12/2025 **Adina Gitomer, Alyssa Smith, Hana Chalmers, Larissa Doroshenko, Robin A. Lange, Alex Madaras, Ryan J. Gallagher, Tamanna Urmi, Brooke Foucault Welles, Social Movements in the Digital Age, in the Handbook of Computational Social Science, December 2025, pages 424 - 437.**

Peer-Reviewed Publications & Accepted Articles

- 03/2026 **Alyssa Hasegawa Smith, Ilya Amburg, Sagar Kumar, Brooke Foucault Welles, Nicholas W. Landry, A Blue Start: A large-scale pairwise and higher-order social network dataset, Nature Scientific Data, March 2026.**

- 02/2026 **Gerardo Flores, Alyssa Hasegawa Smith, Abigail E. Schiff, Julia Fukuyama, Ashia C. Wilson**, A Consequentialist Critique of Binary Classification Evaluation Practices: Theory, Practice, and Tools, Accepted to *AISTATS 2026*.
- 11/2025 **Alyssa Hasegawa Smith, Sagar Kumar, Yukun Yang, and Pranav Goel**, Locating the Asymmetry in Information Flow between Local and National Media on Transgender Discourses, *Bulletin of Applied Transgender Studies*, November 2025.
- 09/2025 **Gerardo Flores, Alyssa Hasegawa Smith, Julie Fukuyama, Ashia C. Wilson**, Aligning Evaluation with Clinical Priorities: Calibration, Label Shift, and Error Costs, *NeurIPS 2025*.
- 04/2025 **Alyssa Hasegawa Smith**, It Has Been Handled: A Story about Ruling Relations and Power in the University Setting, *Journal of Autoethnography*, April 2025.
- 12/2023 **Alyssa Hasegawa Smith, Adina Gitomer, and Brooke Foucault Welles**, You want a piece of me: Britney Spears as a case study on the prominence of hegemonic tales and subversive stories in online media, *First Monday*, December 2023.
- 11/2021 **Vibhu Bhatia, Vidya Prasad Akavoor, Sejin Paik, Lei Guo, Mona Jalal, Alyssa Smith, David Assefa Tofu, Edward Edberg Halim, Yimeng Sun, Margrit Betke, Prakash Ishwar, and Derry Tanti Wijaya**, OpenFraming: Open-sourced Tool for Computational Framing Analysis of Multilingual Data., in Proceedings of the 2021 Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing: System Demonstrations, pages 242-250, Online and Punta Cana, Dominican Republic, November 2021. Association for Computational Linguistics..

Preprints

- 12/2025 **Sharaj Kunjar, Alyssa Hasegawa Smith, Tyler R. Mckenzie, Rushali Mohbe, Samuel V. Scarpino, Brooke Foucault Welles**, Computational frame analysis revisited: On LLMs for studying news coverage, *arXiv Preprint*.

Datasets

- 01/2026 **Alyssa Hasegawa Smith, Ilya Amburg, Sagar Kumar, Brooke Foucault Welles, Nicholas W. Landry**, A Blue Start: A large-scale pairwise and higher-order social network dataset, *SOMAR at ICPSR*.

Articles Under Review

- 05/2026 **Alyssa Hasegawa Smith, Erika Melder, Michael Ann DeVito**, How Distributed, Consensus-Free Folklore Enables Transfeminine Disposability on Bluesky.
- 05/2026 **Alyssa Hasegawa Smith, Ahana Bhattacharya, Holliday Sims, and Kenneth Joseph**, Longitudinal Relational Publics and their Discursive Overlap with Issue Publics .

Invited Talks

- 01/2026 **Alyssa Hasegawa Smith**, *What Shapes Network Structure on Social Media Platforms?*, St. John's College Networks Seminar, Oxford, UK.
- 12/2025 **Alyssa Hasegawa Smith**, *Analyzing Online Structures of Attention*, Women in Network Science (WiNS) Seminar Series.
- 11/2025 **Alyssa Hasegawa Smith**, *Analyzing Online Structures of Attention*, College of the Holy Cross, Worcester, MA.
- 05/2025 **Alyssa Hasegawa Smith, Jonathan Green, David Lazer, Brooke Foucault Welles**, *Emergent structures of attention on social media are driven by amplification and triad transitivity*, Brown University CNTR Reading Group, Providence, RI.

Conference Presentations

- 10/2024 **Alyssa Hasegawa Smith, Sagar Kumar, Yukun Yang, and Pranav Goel**, *An Annotated Dataset of U.S. Transgender News For Determining Agenda-Setting & Information Flows*, Computation and Journalism Symposium, Boston, MA.
- 07/2024 **Alyssa Hasegawa Smith, Sagar Kumar, Yukun Yang, and Pranav Goel**, *Locating the Asymmetry in Information Flow between Local and National Media on Transgender Discourses.*, International Conference on Computational Social Science, Philadelphia, PA.
- 07/2023 **Alyssa Hasegawa Smith, Jonathan Green, David Lazer, Brooke Foucault Welles**, *Attention Brokers: Adapting the Tertius Iungens to an Amplification Paradigm*, Sunbelt, Portland, OR.
- 04/2023 **Rahul Bhargava, Hayden DelCiello, Zhen Guo, Alyssa Hasegawa Smith**, *Pardon Our Dust: Public Data Infrastructure Under Construction*, Digital Humanities Symposium, Cambridge, MA.
- 06/2022 **Alyssa Hasegawa Smith, Jonathan Green, David Lazer, Brooke Foucault Welles**, *Attentional Cat-pital: Jorts The Cat's Disruption of Triad Closure Processes in Social Networks*, PaCSS (Politics and Computational Social Science, Cambridge, MA.

Posters

- 08/2025 **Alyssa Hasegawa Smith, Ilya Amburg, Sagar Kumar, Brooke Foucault Welles, Nicholas Landry**, *A Blue Start: An Open Network Data Resource*, Political Networks and Computational Social Science Conference, Cambridge, MA.
- 07/2024 **Alyssa Hasegawa Smith, Ahana Bhattacharya, Holliday Sims, Kenneth Joseph**, *An Analysis of the Ecosystems of Elites on American Twitter in 2020*, International Conference on Computational Social Science, Philadelphia, PA.
- 06/2021 **Alyssa Hasegawa Smith**, *Doing Data Science With Queer Identities*, PaCSS (Politics and Computational Social Science), Online.

Workshops

- 06/2021 **Layla Hashemi, Amy Magnus, Temitayo Osinubi, and Alyssa Hasegawa Smith**, *Infograffiti*, PaCSS (Politics and Computational Social Science), Online.

Teaching

Fall 2025 **Guest Lecturer.**

PHYS 7332 (Network Science Data): I am serving as a guest lecturer in this course for Fall 2025, providing specific instruction on SQL and machine learning.

Fall 2024 **Co-instructor.**

PHYS 7332 (Network Science Data): This was a graduate-level course with 9 students enrolled. We focused on building competency in Python and related data science tools for network analysis, working with an eye towards scalability and reliability.

Spring 2023 **Guest Lecturer.**

NULab Digital Humanities Project Seminar

Spring 2022 **Guest Lecturer.**

SOCL 4600: Sociology Senior Seminar

Departmental Service

2024 - 2025 **Founded cross-disciplinary mentorship program now on its second cohort of mentorship pods**, Network Science Institute.

2024 **Led job interview practice group**, Network Science Institute.

2024 **Coordinated & moderated industry careers panel**, Network Science Institute.

2023–2024 **President**, Network Science Institute Graduate Student Association.

2022–2023 **Cohort Liaison**, Network Science Institute Graduate Student Association.

Professional Experience

- May **Kayak Software Corporation**, *Labs Data Scientist*.
2019–May Built data pipelines and machine learning models. Led the LGBTQ+ Employee Resource Group
2021
- July **Kensho Technologies**, *Graph Data Engineer*.
2017–March Built data infrastructure for graph machine learning models
2019

Service to Profession

- 08/2025 **Reviewer**, *Computers in Human Behavior Reports*.
06/2025 **Co-Reviewer**, *Nature Communications*.
03/2025 **Reviewer**, *ICWSM 2025*.
01/2025 **Program Committee**, *WebSci 2025*.
04/2025 **Reviewer**, *NetSci 2025*.
02/2024; **Reviewer**, *First Monday*.
04/2025
02/2023 **Reviewer**, *Digital Humanities Quarterly*.

References

Prof. Brooke Foucault Welles (Co-Advisor): b.welles@northeastern.edu
Prof. David Lazer (Co-Advisor): d.lazer@northeastern.edu
Prof. Michael Ann DeVito (Committee Member): m.devito@northeastern.edu